On a Roll

After a string of successes in 2024, music composer duo Sachin-Jigar are looking forward to several major releases in 2025

SACHIN-JIGAR have at least five OSTs lined up in 2025 and have set their sights on playing in North America



TOP DRAW Sachin (left) and Jigar had earlier worked for Rajesh Roshan and Pritam

Among all Hindi film composers, 2024 was clearly the year of Sachin-Jigar. The duo of Sachin Sanghvi and Jigar Saraiya tallied hits with songs from *Teri Baaton Mein Aisa Uljha Jiya*, *Munjya*, *Vicky Vidya Ka Woh Wala Video* and, most notably, 2024's biggest Bollywood blockbuster *Stree 2*. "The highlight was the fact that our biggest track is sung by a relatively new name," says Sachin, referring to 'Aaj Ki Raat', the chart-topper from *Stree 2* rendered by Madhubanti Bagchi.

Though it comprised just four songs, the horror-comedy's soundtrack was among the rare OSTs from which each tune turned into a smash. "There have been superhit films where our music hasn't worked, and we've made great soundtracks for films that flopped," says Jigar. "It's very rare that the entire package works."

Sachin and he, who broke through in 2011 with two strikingly different songs, the dance number 'Char Baj Gaye' from *F.A.L.T.U* and the soulful ballad 'Saibo' from *Shor in the City*, say there wasn't a specific turning point in their career. Instead, things started changing when filmmakers began placing their trust in their skills. Of these, the pair single out producer Dinesh Vijan, the founder of Maddock Films, the company behind four of the six OSTs they contributed to in 2024. "When the creative team has faith in each other, we can worry about the crux of the content [versus what's trending]," says Sachin.

If their upcoming projects stick to their release schedules, then Sachin-Jigar will have an even busier 2025. The list includes *Ikkis*, *Param Sundari* and *Thama* with Maddock; *Naadaniyaan* with Dharma Productions; and *Maalik* with Tips Films. A key reason for their popularity is the duo's knack of imbibing influences from the icons that preceded them.

The musicians, who were introduced to each other by Amit Trivedi, first worked together as arrangers for Rajesh Roshan and then as assistants to Pritam who perhaps made the strongest impression on them. With Roshan, they learned "how the arrangement needs to be woven with a tune", and from Pritam how to find "the sweet spot between art and commerce".

As composers, they're against recreations of older compositions but the demand was so high that they launched a separate entity called White Noise Productions to execute them. This frees them to focus on "the music we've always wanted to do" and to continue to spotlight fresh voices—something they'll be partially aided in by their stint as judges on the reality TV singing talent show *Sa Re Ga Ma Pa*. After their tour of Australia and the success of their musical *Rajadhiraaj*, based on the life of Lord Krishna, they've now set their sights on playing in North America this year and staging a Broadway play sometime in the near future. "Wherever there's scope to grow, there's excitement," says Jigar. ■

–Amit Gurbaxani